# Baofeng UV-5R Quick Guide

Trumpet Net

Most days you only need the first box. The back lists every menu and the setting we suggest.

## THE EVERYDAY BASICS

1. **On and volume:** turn the top knob.
2. **Channel mode:** the screen should show a channel name with a small channel number on the right. If you see a bare frequency, press [VFO/MR].
3. **Pick a channel:** type three digits (`0 3 1` for channel 31) or use [▲] [▼].
4. **Talk:** hold **PTT** (push-to-talk, the big side button), wait one second, speak across the mic a few inches away, then let go. Wait for the other station before talking again.

## BUTTONS

| | |
|---|---|
| **PTT** | Push-to-talk. Hold to transmit. |
| **CALL** | Above PTT. Press: FM broadcast radio. **Hold: loud alarm.** |
| **MONI** | Below PTT. Press: flashlight. Hold: hear weak stations. |
| **VFO/MR** | Frequency mode (VFO, variable frequency oscillator) or channel mode (MR, memory recall). |
| **A/B** | Top line (A) or bottom line (B). |
| **BAND** | Frequency mode: VHF (very high frequency, 2m) or UHF (ultra high frequency, 70cm). |
| * **SCAN** | Hold: scan. Press again to stop. |
| # 🔒 | Press: high/low power. Hold: lock or unlock the keypad. |
| **MENU** | Open settings and confirm. **EXIT** backs out. |

## CHANGE ANY SETTING

1. Press [MENU], then type the menu number (`7` for dual watch).
2. Press [MENU] to open it.
3. Use [▲] [▼] to choose.
4. Press [MENU] to save, then [EXIT].

Some menus only work in frequency mode. Channel settings are set by CHIRP.

## LISTEN TO TWO CHANNELS (DUAL WATCH)

1. **MENU 7 (TDR)** → ON.
2. Press [A/B] to pick a line, choose its channel. Repeat for the other line.
3. **MENU 34 (TDR-AB)** → OFF, so you answer on the line that just spoke. A or B always transmits on that line.
4. **MENU 21 / 22 (MDF-A, MDF-B)** → NAME, to show channel names.

It flips between the two fast. While one line is busy, the other is muted.

## SCAN

In channel mode, hold [* SCAN]. The radio steps through the scan list (3, 20, 23, 38, 39, 40, 50, 60, 70, 80, 90, 100) and stops on any voice. **MENU 18 (SC-REV)** sets when it moves on: **TO** after 5 seconds, **CO** when the talking stops (best for us), **SE** stays put.

## ADD A CHANNEL BY HAND

1. Press [VFO/MR] for frequency mode, then type the frequency (`146520`).
2. Repeater only: **MENU 25 (SFT-D)** shift `+` or `−`, **MENU 26 (OFFSET)** `00.600` on 2m, `05.000` on 70cm, **MENU 13 (T-CTCS)** tone.
3. Tone both ways (like TPT): also **MENU 11 (R-CTCS)**, same tone.
4. **MENU 27 (MEM-CH)**, pick an empty channel, [MENU] to store, [EXIT].
5. Press [VFO/MR] to go back to channels.

CTCSS (continuous tone-coded squelch system) is the "privacy code": a hidden tone that opens the other radio. It doesn't make you private. Names need CHIRP.

## SOMETHING'S WRONG?

| | |
|---|---|
| **No sound** | Turn up the volume. Hold MONI to check for weak signals. Squelch (MENU 0) should be 3–5. |
| **Keys dead** | Keypad is locked. Hold [#]. |
| **Beeps, no TX** | Receive-only channel (weather), a frequency the radio won't allow, or BCL (MENU 23) on a busy channel. |
| **Repeater quiet** | Wrong tone or shift. Check the channel against the trifold. |
| **Numbers, no names** | Press [VFO/MR], or set MENU 21/22 to NAME. |
| **Alarm going off** | Press [CALL] again. |
| **Wrong list** | Channel 0 (or 108) should say `VER 15`. If not, reprogram with CHIRP. |

## NEVER

- **MENU 40 (RESET) → ALL** erases every channel. Only CHIRP can put them back.
- Transmit without the antenna on. It can damage the radio.
- Transmit on a ham or GMRS channel without the license, except when a life is in danger.

Menu numbers are for the standard UV-5R (also UV-5RA, 5R+, 5RE, which match closely). If a number seems off, go by the menu name on the screen. Printed side 2: every menu.

# Every menu

Shaded = settings worth knowing · bold = Trumpet Net suggestion

| # | SCREEN | WHAT IT DOES | SUGGEST |
|---|---|---|---|
| 0 | SQL | Squelch: how strong a signal must be before you hear it. Higher is quieter but misses weak stations. | **3–5** |
| 1 | STEP | Tuning step in frequency mode. | **12.5K (5K on 2m)** |
| 2 | TXP | Transmit power, high or low. Same as a short press of [#]. | **LOW nearby, HIGH far** |
| 3 | SAVE | Battery saver: the receiver naps between checks. | **ON (default)** |
| 4 | VOX | Voice-operated transmit: talks when it hears you, no PTT. Easy to key up by accident. | **OFF** |
| 5 | WN | Wide or narrow bandwidth. FRS 8–14 and MURS 1–3 are narrow. | **leave to CHIRP** |
| 6 | ABR | How long the backlight stays on, in seconds. | **5** |
| 7 | TDR | Dual watch: watch line A and line B. See side 1. | **your choice** |
| 8 | BEEP | Keypad beeps. | **OFF when quiet matters** |
| 9 | TOT | Time-out timer: stops transmitting after this many seconds, so a stuck PTT can't jam a channel. | **60** |
| 10 | R-DCS | Receive digital code (DCS, digital-coded squelch). A digital privacy code. | **leave to CHIRP** |
| 11 | R-CTCS | Receive tone (CTCSS privacy code). Only opens for radios sending this tone. | **leave to CHIRP** |
| 12 | T-DCS | Transmit digital code. | **leave to CHIRP** |
| 13 | T-CTCS | Transmit tone. Most repeaters need one. | **leave to CHIRP** |
| 14 | VOICE | Spoken prompts when you press keys. | **OFF or ENG** |
| 15 | ANI-ID | Radio's ID code (ANI, automatic number identification). Read-only. | **—** |
| 16 | DTMFST | Whether you hear the touch-tones (DTMF, dual-tone multi-frequency) the radio sends. | **OFF** |
| 17 | S-CODE | Which ID code PTT-ID sends. | **—** |
| 18 | SC-REV | Scan resume: TO after 5 seconds, CO when talking stops, SE stops for good. | **CO** |
| 19 | PTT-ID | Sends an ID burst when you key up. Annoying to others. | **OFF** |
| 20 | PTT-LT | Delay before the PTT-ID burst. | **—** |
| 21 | MDF-A | What line A shows: frequency, channel number, or NAME. | **NAME** |
| 22 | MDF-B | Same for line B. | **NAME** |
| 23 | BCL | Busy channel lockout: won't transmit over someone. Also blocks you in an emergency. | **OFF** |
| 24 | AUTOLK | Locks the keypad after a few seconds idle. | **OFF (hold # instead)** |
| 25 | SFT-D | Repeater shift direction: + or – (or off). Frequency mode. | **for hand entry** |
| 26 | OFFSET | Repeater offset: 0.600 MHz on 2m, 5.000 on 70cm and GMRS. | **for hand entry** |
| 27 | MEM-CH | Save the line A frequency into a channel (000–127). | **for hand entry** |
| 28 | DEL-CH | Erase one channel. Careful: don't erase the list. | **—** |
| 29 | WT-LED | Screen color while idle. | **your choice** |
| 30 | RX-LED | Screen color while receiving. | **your choice** |
| 31 | TX-LED | Screen color while transmitting. | **your choice** |
| 32 | AL-MOD | What the alarm does: SITE sounds only here, TONE and CODE also transmit. | **SITE** |
| 33 | BAND | VHF or UHF for the frequency line. | **—** |
| 34 | TDR-AB | In dual watch, which line you transmit on after a call. OFF answers on the line that spoke. | **OFF** |
| 35 | STE | Cuts the short burst of noise at the end of a call (STE, squelch tail elimination), radio to radio. | **ON** |
| 36 | RP-STE | Same, through a repeater. | **OFF** |
| 37 | RPT-RL | Delay for the repeater's tail tone. | **OFF** |
| 38 | PONMSG | What shows at power on: FULL screen test or a MSG. | **your choice** |
| 39 | ROGER | Roger beep at the end of each transmission. Say "over" instead. | **OFF** |
| 40 | RESET | VFO resets settings only. **ALL erases every channel.** | **never ALL** |

Menu list checked against Jim Unroe (KC9HI), "UV-5R Menu Definitions," miklor.com, and essexham.co.uk's UV-5R guide. Firmware differences between batches can move a menu or rename an option. Settings marked "leave to CHIRP" are already set on each channel by the Trumpet Net list. www.deangadberry.com/trumpetnet